# “Setting Up Windows Server 2022 Virtual Machine on Hyper-V + Adding & Mounting 10 GB Disk as Drive H:” Step-by-Step Guide

**Version: 1.1 (November 19, 2025)**
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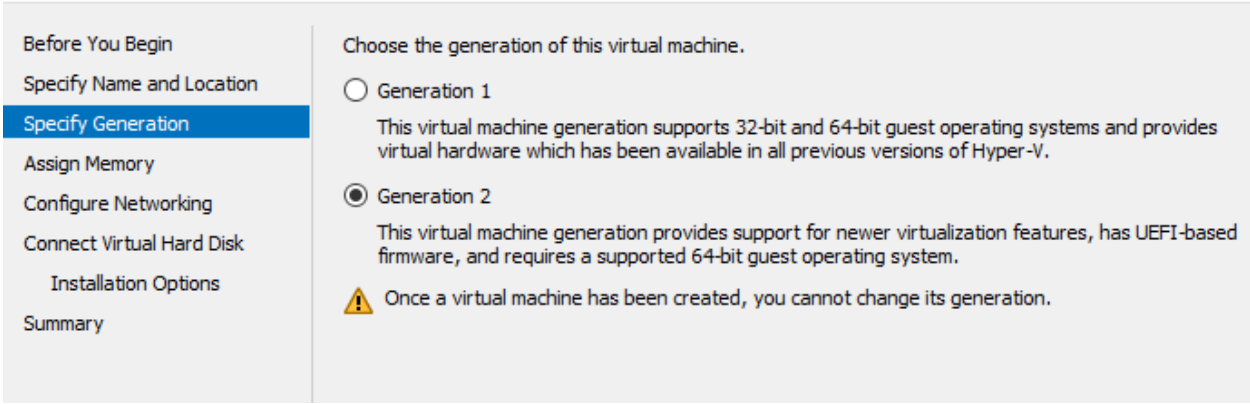
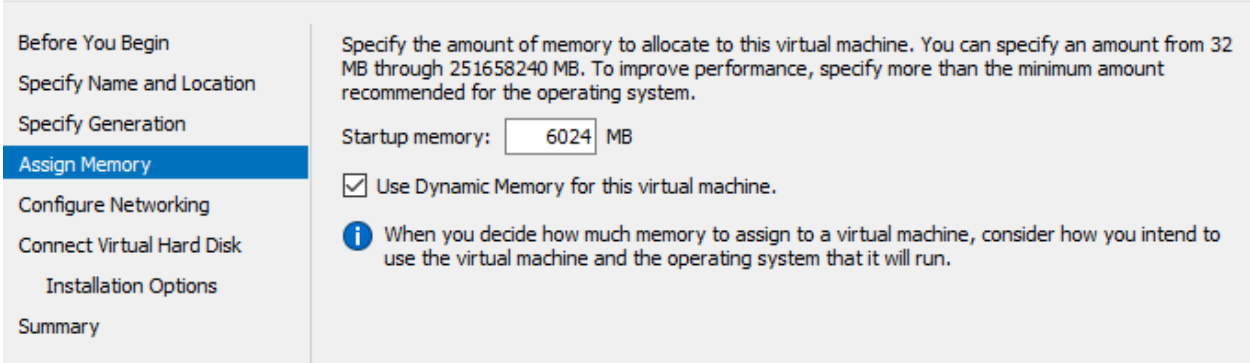
## 1. Open Hyper-V Manager & Create a New Virtual Machine

Launch Hyper-V Manager. Right-click host system, select **New**, then **Virtual Machine**.

Assign the name **WinServer2022** to the new VM and choose **Generation 2**. This generation is required for features such as Secure Boot.

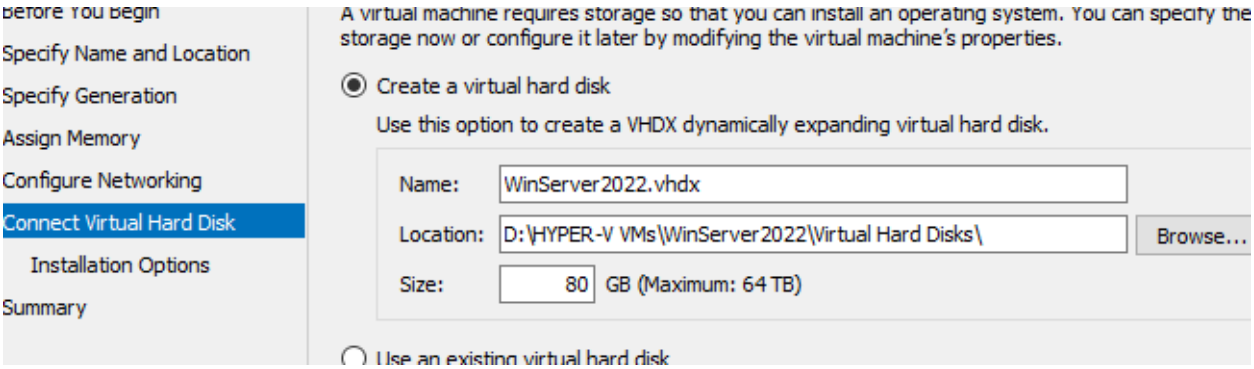



Set the memory allocation to a minimum of **4096** MB and enable **Dynamic Memory to optimize resource usage**.

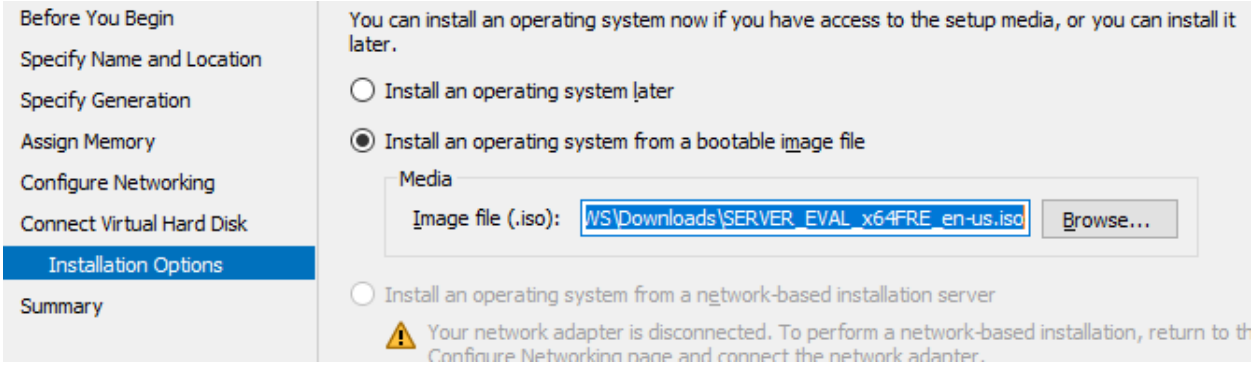


Configure networking by selecting an External Switch for network connectivity (for now I’ll skip the network configuration).

Create a new virtual hard disk with a size of **80 GB** in **VHDX format**.



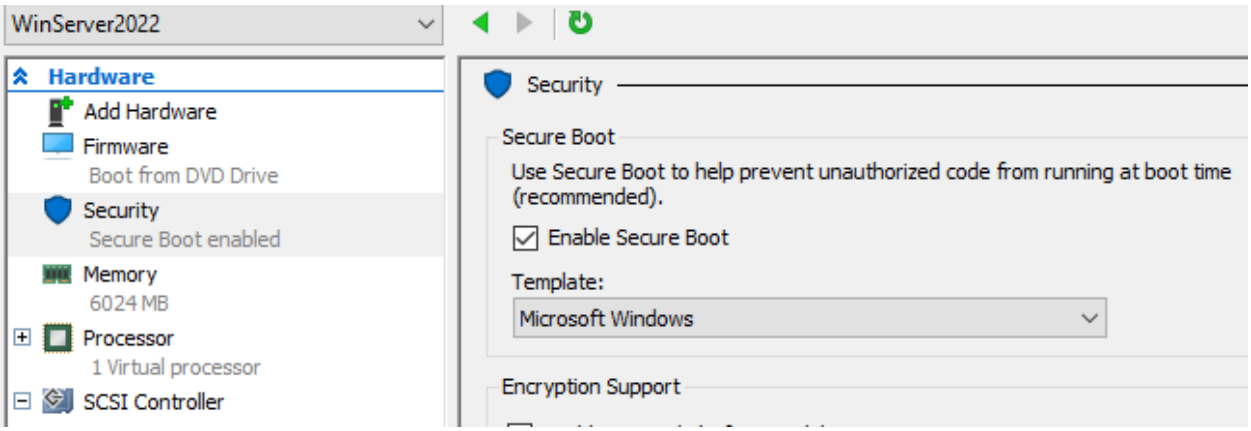

For installation options, point to the Windows Server 2022 ISO file. Click Finish to create the virtual machine.



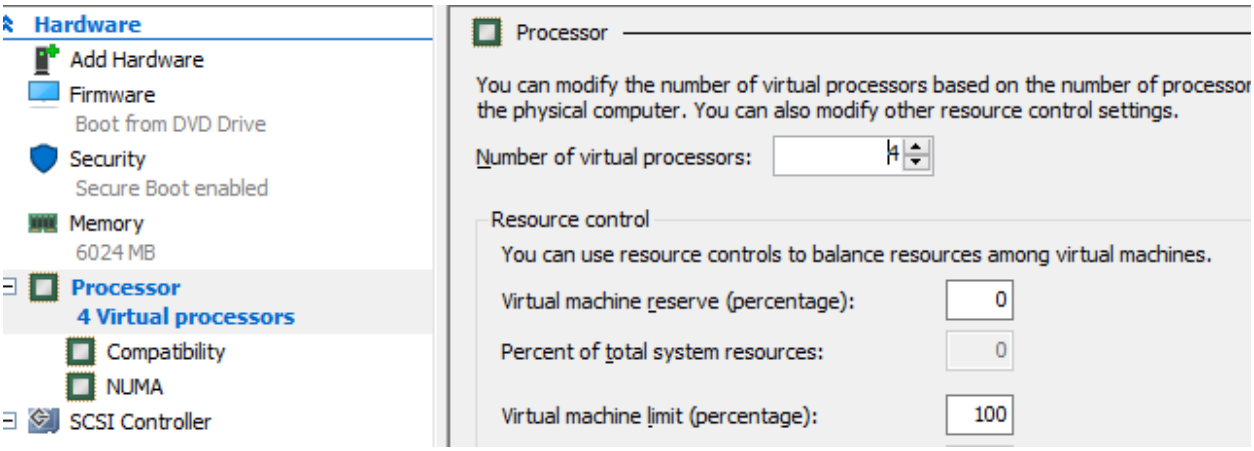

## 2. Recommended VM Settings Before First Boot

Before starting the VM for the first time, review and adjust key settings:

- Under Security, enable **Secure Boot** using the Microsoft Windows template.

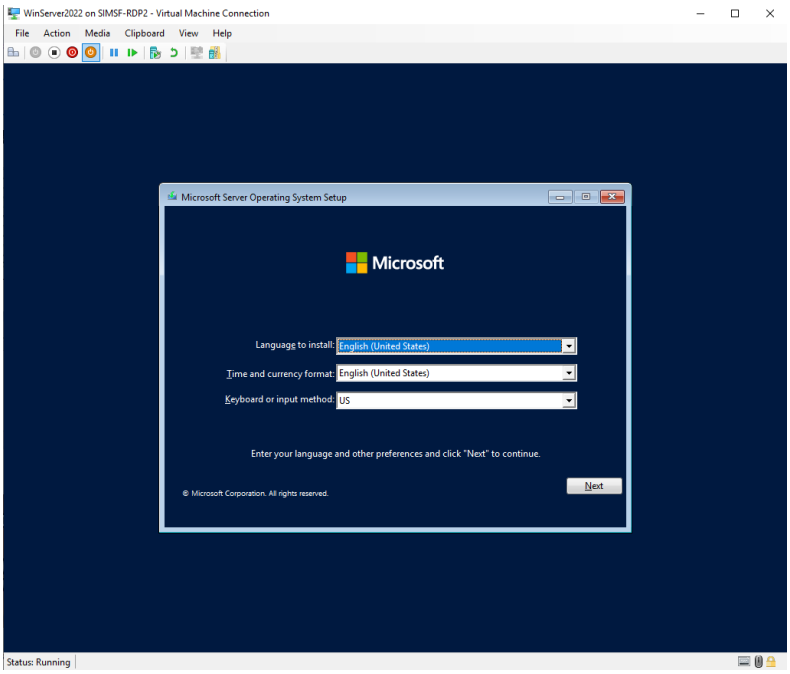



- Set Processor to use at least 4 vCPUs for improved performance.

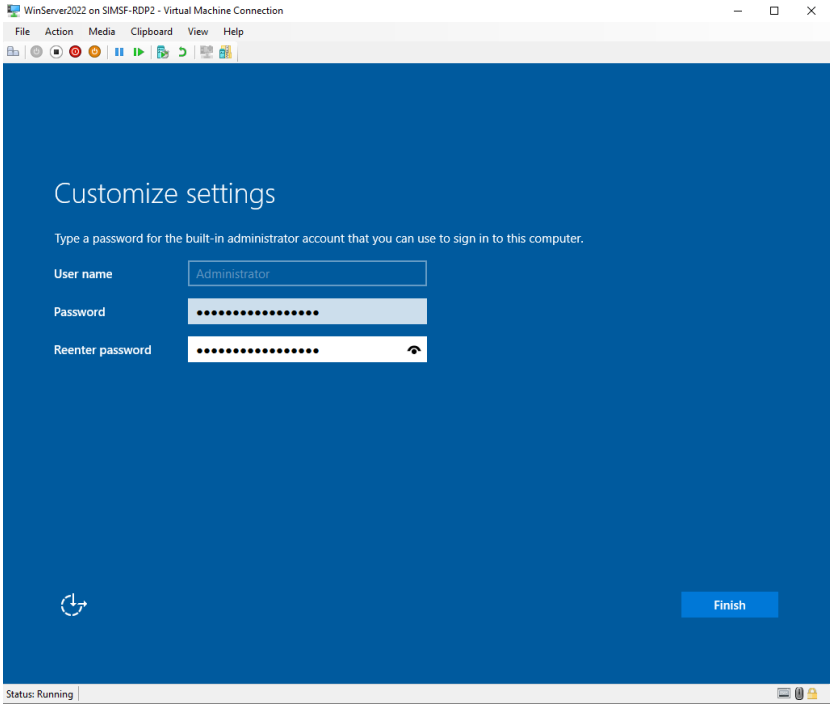



## 3. Start the VM and Install Windows Server 2022

Start the virtual machine and connect to it. When the Windows Setup boots, select Install now, choose Desktop Experience, and proceed with a Custom installation. Select the 80 GB virtual disk created earlier.




Once installation is complete, set the password for the Administrator account.

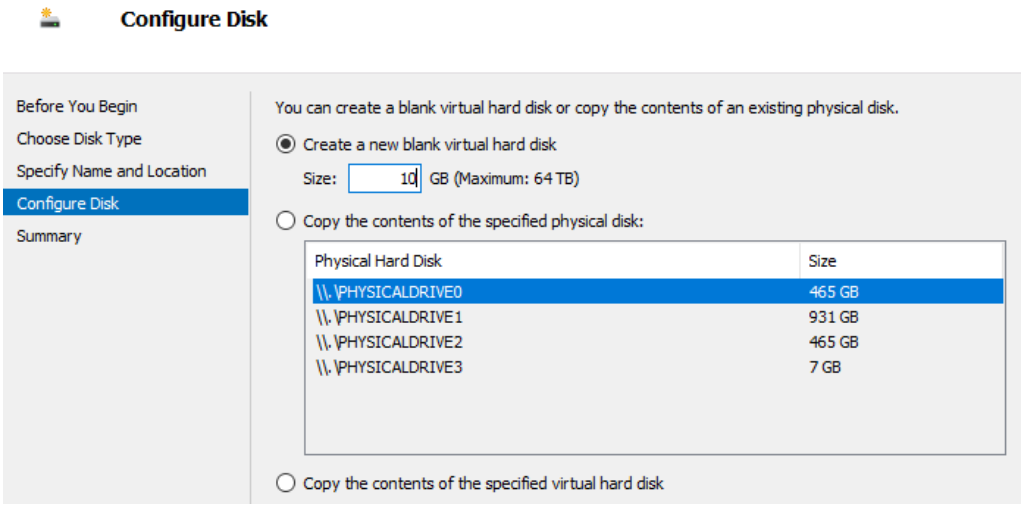


# 4. Add the 10 GB Extra Disk (Online – No Shutdown Needed)

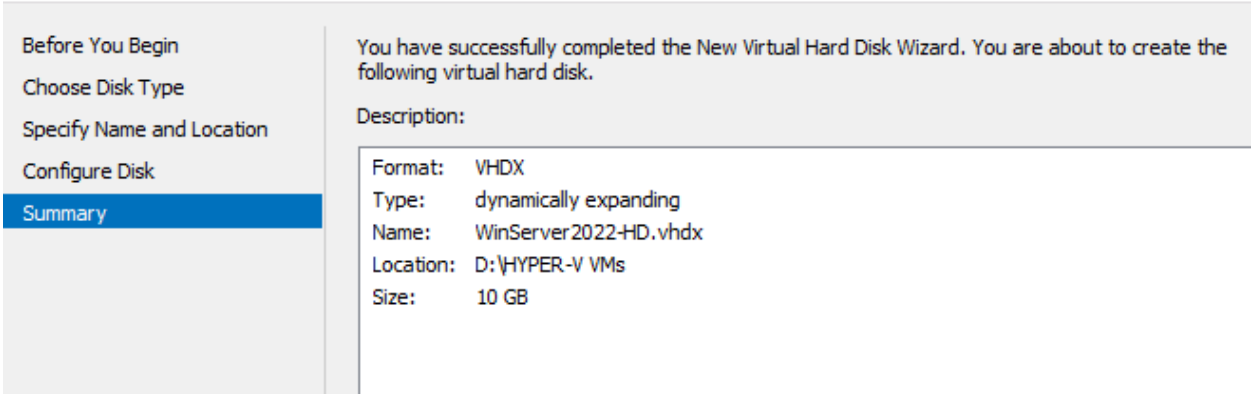
While the VM is running, open **Hyper-V Manager**, right-click the VM, and select **Settings**.

On the **SCSI Controller**, choose **Hard Drive**, then click **Add** and select **New** to create a new virtual hard disk.

In the wizard, select the **VHDX** format, choose **Dynamically expanding**, and set the size to **10 GB**. Name the disk appropriately and confirm the settings.

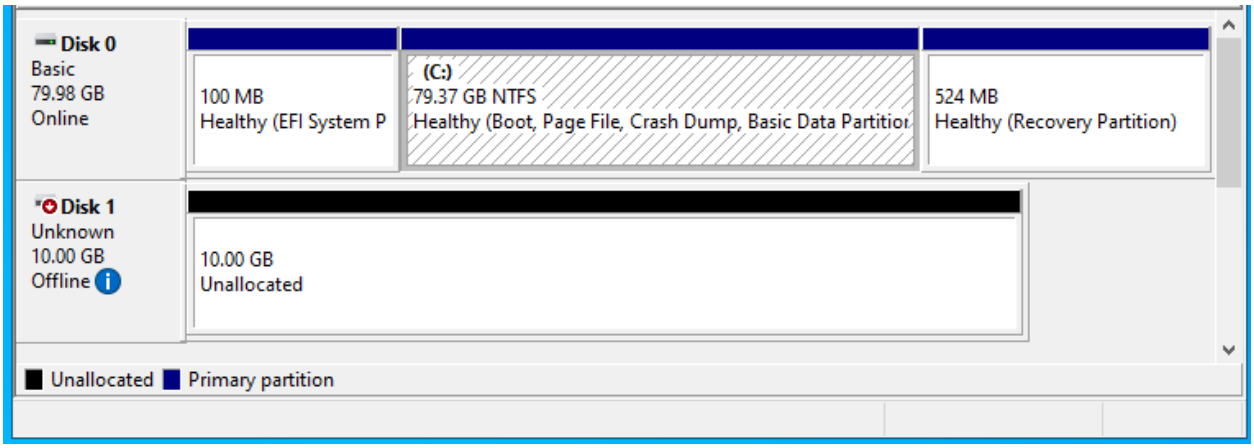



Click Apply and OK. The disk will be added while the VM remains operational, thanks to Generation 2 and Integration Services.

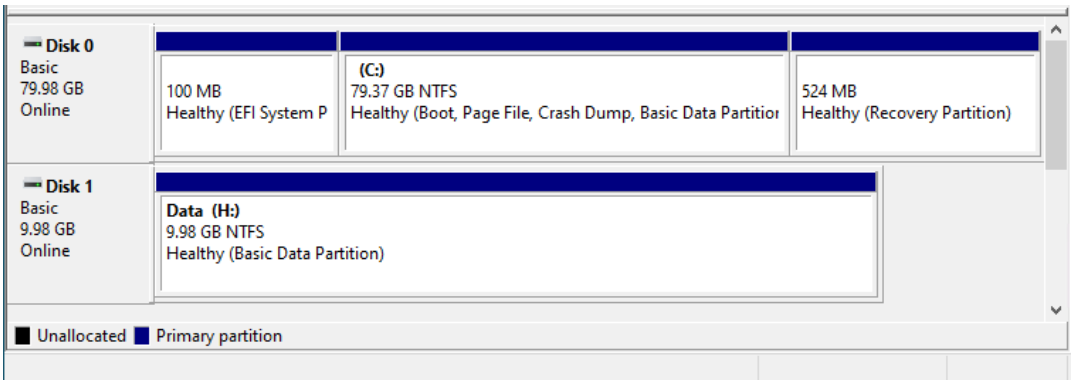


# 5. Initialize & Format the New Disk Inside the Guest

Log into your Windows Server 2022 VM. Right-click **Start** and open **Disk Management**. The new disk will appear as Disk 1 – Unknown – 10.00 GB.



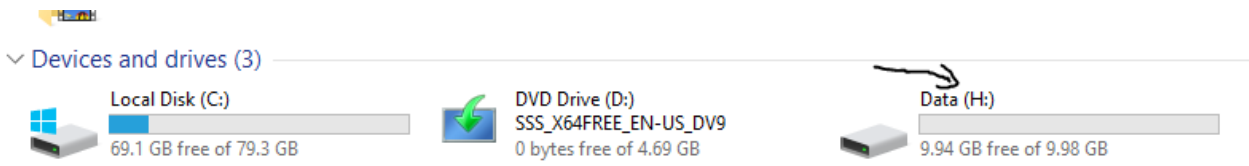

1. Right-click **Disk 1** and select **Online** to bring this disk online.
2. Right-click **Disk 1** and select **Initialize Disk**. Choose **GPT** as the partition style and click **OK**.
3. Right-click the unallocated space on the disk and choose **New Simple Volume**.
4. Use the full **10 GB** for the volume and assign the drive letter **H:**.
5. Format the partition as **NTFS**, use **Quick Format**, and label the volume (e.g., "**Data**" or any preferred name).
6. Complete the wizard to finish setup.

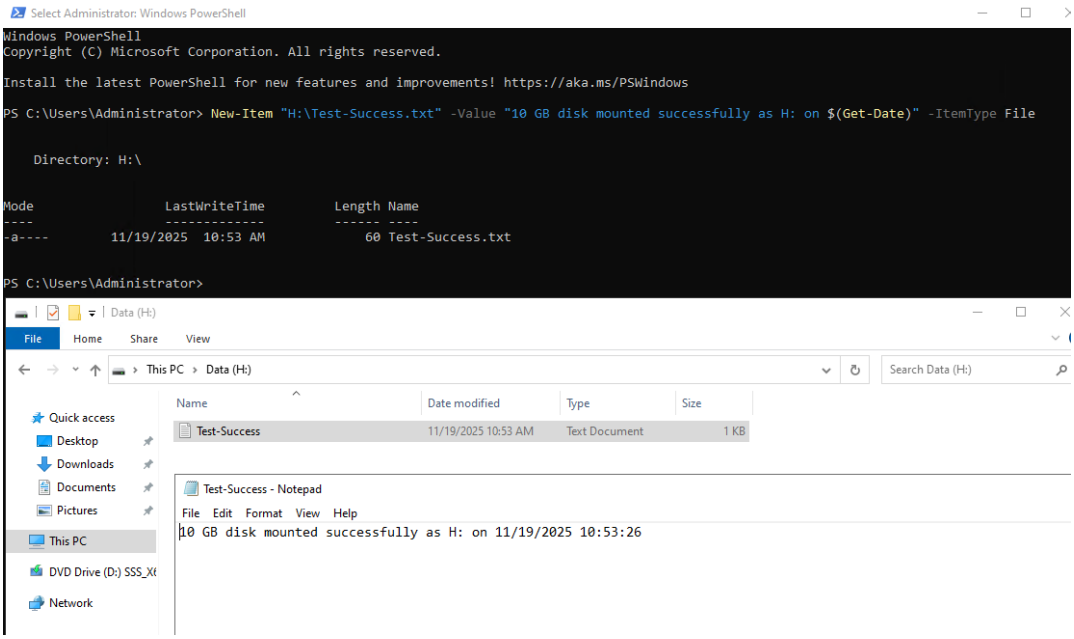



The new disk will now be ready and visible as drive H: in the system.

# 6. Verify the New Drive Works

Open File Explorer and navigate to This PC. Confirm that the H: drive appears.




To test the new disk, create a file using PowerShell:

New-Item "H:\Test-Success.txt" -Value "10 GB disk mounted successfully as H: on $(Get-Date)" -ItemType File